

Phils Promise Aggressive Ball Club for Elmira

Four ranking members of the Philadelphia Phillies organization didn't promise Elmira baseball fans a winner in 1959, but they vowed it would be a young, battling club, at the annual Elmira Baseball banquet last night in the Mark Twain Hotel.

Eddie Sawyer, Phillies' manager; Benny Bengough, Phils' coach; Gene Martin, farm director of the Phils' organization; and Andy Seminick, new Pioneer manager, said they liked Elmira, and "glad that the Elmira franchise is part of the Phils' system."

Sawyer, the guest of honor, said that the Phillies intend to have a young, progressive organization, and that owner Bob Carpenter is not afraid to spend any of his millions to get one.

He said Elmira was fortunate to have an aggressive person like Seminick as manager and cited several instances to prove Andy's aggressiveness.

Bengough said the Phillies plan to send to Elmira a high type of ball player, and said that the boys will need the encouragement of all Elmira and area fans.

"You can be sure Andy will get a lot out of them and develop a real ball club."

Martin said that the Phils' system is doing quite well now and should continue to improve to become one of the most outstanding in baseball eventually.

"Elmira will have real good baseball, maybe not in 1959, but we'll make a real, sincere effort to give Elmira the club they want."

"You have a real, solid guy in Seminick, and he'll do an outstanding job for you and with young players."

Martin introduced Seminick who received a tremendous ovation from the approximately 200 persons present.

Seminick said he was happy to be in Elmira with his fine park, and was grateful to the Phillies organization for the opportunity to manage. He said he will soon go to the Phillies rookie camp at Leesburg, Fla. to look over the new crop of ball players and see what he can bring back to Elmira.

Ed Kelly, general manager of the Elmira club, said that despite its eighth place finish last year, the Pioneers were one of the few minor clubs to show a profit.

Jim Morse was toastmaster for the event, arranged by the

Elmira Booster Club.

Others who spoke briefly were Mayor Edward A. Mooers, City Manager Angus Johnson, Rev. Joseph F. Hogan, Notre Dame High school chaplain; Andy Cohen, former Elmira infielder; W. Frank Bedenk, president of the Elmira Baseball Club; Art Gott, president of the Booster Club; and Vincent McNamara of Olean, New York - Penn League president.

At a meeting of the club board of directors preceding the banquet, Miss Mary-Margaret Kelly and Miss Madge Mitchell were named to the all-male board. The League and league writers association also held sessions during the afternoon.

Olmedo Downs Fraser to Win Aussie Net Title

Adelaide, Australia (UPI) — Alex Olmedo of Peru and Los Angeles won his first major tennis title today when he captured the Australian crown by defeating Neale Fraser, 6-1, 6-2, 3-6, 6-3.

Olmedo rounded out a triumphant day for the United States before a crowd of 6,000. Earl Buchholz, 18-year-old St. Louis star, won the junior title by defeating Marty Mulligan of Australia, 3-6, 6-3, 6-3. Buchholz now holds the four major junior titles—Wimbledon, United States, French and Australian.

Olmedo, 22, hero of the United States triumph over Australia in the Davis Cup challenge round last month, is the fourth United States representative to win the Australian crown, following F. B. Alexander (1908), Don Budge (1938) and Dick Savitt (1951).

Olmedo has been hampered by a pulled stomach muscle but it took him just 86 minutes to defeat Fraser, the Australian left-hander who is regarded as this country's top amateur since Ashley Cooper and Mal Anderson turned pro.

The outcome never was in doubt. Olmedo played with the same power and skill he displayed in his Davis Cup matches. He was equally effective on all parts of the court.